

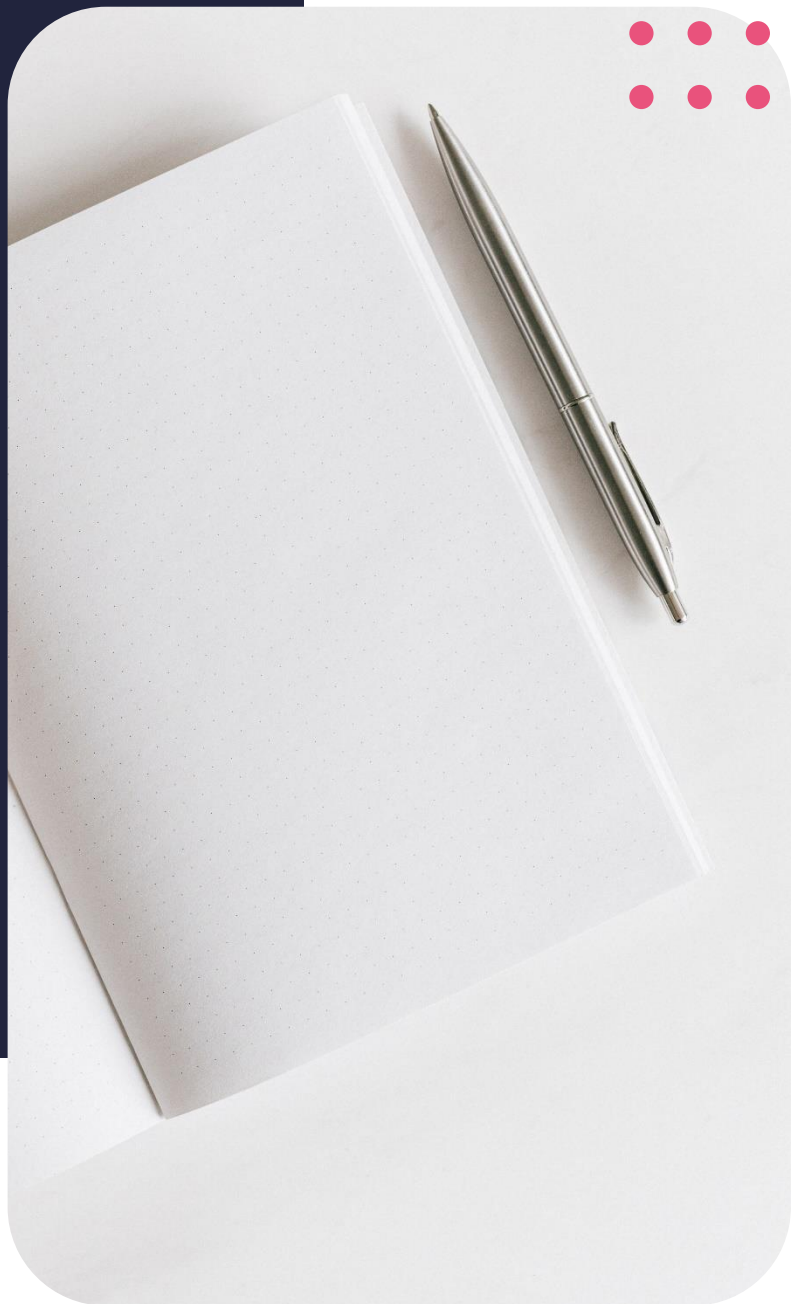
Diploma in Leadership & Management

Your Guide to Diversity Management



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Lesson 7 Objectives

- Future leadership and transformational roles
- Leading in a multi-generational environment
- Acquiring a multicultural mindset

Lesson Introduction

Diversity management is a competency that all managers and leaders need. Diversity challenges is a universal struggle that all managers and leaders face regardless of the country you work in. Diversity management training leads to managers and leaders making better decisions and understanding the difference in those around us.

"Inclusion is not a matter of political correctness. It is the key to growth". — Jesse Jackson

Key Reading Materials

- <https://www.monster.com/career-advice/article/manage-different-generations-work>
- <https://harver.com/blog/generational-diversity-in-the-workplace/>
- <https://smallbusiness.chron.com/definition-multicultural-workplace-15469.html>
- <https://www.nintex.com/blog/7-advantages-multicultural-workplace/>

Self-Assessment: Company Culture

- **The bias test:** <https://implicit.harvard.edu/implicit/takeatest.html>

Working with different generations in the workplace



Gen Z

Born Between
1995 - 2015



Millennial

Born Between
1980 - 1994



Gen X

Born Between
1965 - 1979



Baby Boomer

Born Between
1944 - 1964

According to (Desjardins, 2019), there are approaches you can take as a manager and leader to better work with different generations in the workplace. Please note the following directly from the website - I have merely tabulated it.

		Generation			
		Baby Boomers	Generation X	Millennials	Generation Z
	Born between	1944 - 1964	1965 - 1979	1980 - 1994	1995 - 2015
Communication	% in-person	40	34	31	26
	% by email	35	34	33	16
	% by phone (chat)	13	13	12	31
Motivation		• health insurance • a boss worthy of respect • salary	• salary • job security • job challenges/excitement	• salary • job challenges/excitement • ability to pursue passion	• salary • ability to pursue passion • job security
Loyalty to the company (in years)		8	7	5	3

How to better manage your unconscious bias at work



According to (Loehr, 2016), the following are key things all employees can take to better manage their unconscious bias at work.

Take the implicit associations test

Make sure to take the bias test that is linked at the top of the document. The test will help guide you on your unconscious bias that may influence the way in which you interact with other people.

Watch your language

Your language can be very harmful at work. You need to be conscious of how you address people and can impact people in a negative way.

Examples:

Instead of using:	Use:
You guys	everyone, all of you, team
The kid	the young person, young lady, young man
Oh man or Oh brother	wow, ugh, yikes
Attendees and their wives	attendees and their guests...

Identify where your bias starts

For example, you might attract tasks or assignments to the employees you more relate to.

Things for which to keep an eye out

- Is there a pattern when it comes to the employee you hire?
- Is there a pattern when you assign work?
- Is there a pattern when you conduct performance evaluations?
- Is there a pattern when you determine the pay, bonus or raise of the employees?

Encourage accountability

Focus on a company culture where people can be honest about what makes them comfortable and uncomfortable. There should be a process in place for employees to report issues where they have felt uncomfortable.

Continue training

Offer employees and management more through training when it comes to their bias management. This is not a once-off process and you're done. This is a process that needs a lot of commitment from the company and employees to improve the state of the company.

How to achieve a multicultural mindset



Develop your characteristics

You must be open to other people, new experiences, and embrace a growth mindset. This all adds to your approach when it comes to working with others and yourself. It is key to be open, socially aware, flexible, and curious about others.

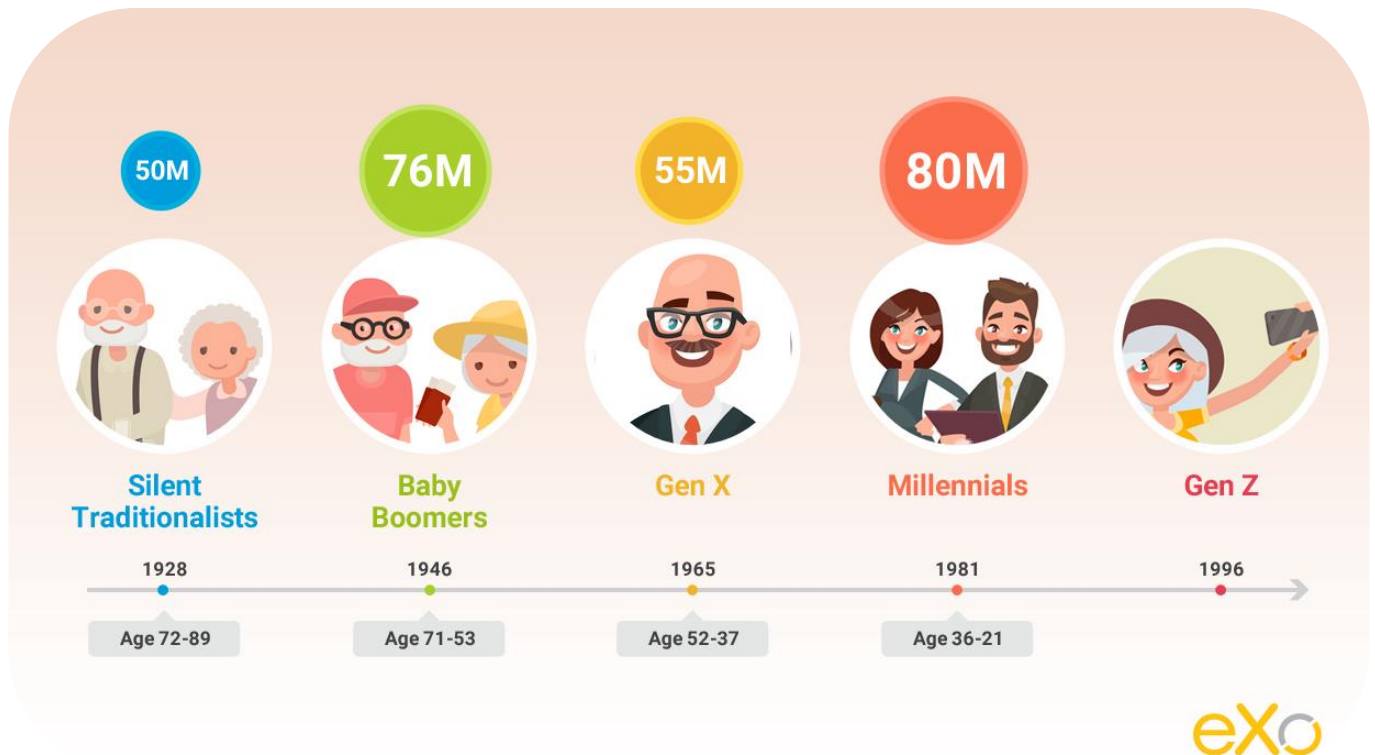
Learn more about the country and culture that you're working in

Make sure that you understand what the employees in your company and country value. This will influence the way in which you manage your team. This also means that you are actively trying to improve your bias and not force your way of thinking on your employees. Find the balance between what you want, what the company wants and what the employees want.

Know your employee

Take the time to invest time and get to know and understand your employees. It's very important to truly understand your team. You will be able to better understand their needs and what they want and need from the company. This will create better relationships in your team and with the company.

How to manage different generations



As stated by (Hoon, 2019), there are different things to consider when working with different generations.

Recognize and embrace the difference

A great way to outline what is different is great about the different people and generations you find in your workplace. A survey is a great way to outline overlapping things you all share or things that are unique and great about each generation. It's a great way to appreciate each other and start to learn from different groups.

Break out the routines

Come up with creative and innovative ways in which you can improve the working environment for all your employees. Have think tanks where employees can work as a team to think of better ways to improve the office, operations, goals and many more. Avoid getting trapped in the same routine without improvement.

Be aware of hurdles each generation faces

The aim is to better understand the needs of each generation and with that, the common issues that the employees from each generation face. By knowing the issues, you can better create a supportive environment at work that can be used to overcome the overlapping issues.

Team up

Allow for employees from different generations to work on projects or tasks. You can also assign a mentorship program for which employees can volunteer to sign up. For example, a young employee can be mentored by an experienced leader/manager. On the other side, an older employee can be mentored by a young employee to improve his/her tech skills.

Update managers and leaders

“For example, if you find that younger employees are more likely to job hop— and a 2016 study did, indeed, report that a whopping 21% of Millennials left their jobs during that year compared to just 7% of older employees— make sure that your fellow managers are tuned into that issue so they can better hold onto younger employees they can’t afford to lose”. (Hoon, 2019). Share the knowledge and the information that you receive about your employees to not only improve your team but the company.

Bibliography

Desjardins, J. (2019, May 30). *How Different Generations Approach Work*. Retrieved from Visual Capitalist : <https://www.visualcapitalist.com/generations-approach-workplace/>

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